

PURPOSE: To allow SGA to enact Honor Court elections

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BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE

SECTION ONE (DEFINITIONS):

Honor Court: a judicial, student-led system through which residential infractions can be appealed.

SECTION TWO (REASONING):

Last year, four current seniors (2 Goen and 2 Frazer) were elected to MSMS's Honor Court. These elections were carried out by Ms. LeAnn Alexander, who formerly held the position of the Director of Student Affairs.

Currently, the newly inducted Student Affairs Office is overloaded, and junior members of the Honor Court haven't been able to be elected. Thus, the Honor Court is not functioning as intended. However, it seems silly that students shouldn't have access to an appeals system because administration doesn't have time to put it into action.

Because of this, a new system of Honor Court elections should be allowed. In this bill, it is proposed that two systems of elections shall be valid for the election of Honor Court justices: both the old way, through the Student Affairs Office, and a new way, through SGA (presumably the Election Commissioner).

While this change would possibly make it harder to keep the identities of the elected justices a secret, it's better to have a slightly flawed court than no court at all. Also, the idea of secret justices is one that is never mentioned in the Handbook's provisions. However, in this system it is assumed that Honor Court elections through SGA will be overseen by the SGA President, Vice President, Secretary, and Election Commissioner, and information regarding the court will not be spread outside of this group.

SECTION THREE (SPECIFIC CHANGE):

On Page 141 of the Student Handbook (PDF page 146), the following will be changed:

The Honor Court will be made up of six (6) students, four (4) seniors, (2 males and 2 females) and two (2) juniors, (one male and one female). Additionally, two (2) seniors (1 male and 1 female), and two (2) junior, (one male and one female) will be elected to serve as alternates and

fill empty positions when needed. The two (2) junior justices and two (2) junior alternates will become the four (4) senior justices the next school year. The Director for Students Affairs shall serve as Honor Court Advisor.

Student representatives to the court shall be elected by the student body. The election shall be overseen by either the Director for Student Affairs or the SGA Officers.